Why requirements matter

Most project failures trace back to unclear or changing requirements. Requirements engineering is the discipline of discovering, documenting and managing them.

Functional requirements

Describe what the system must do: features, behaviours and responses to inputs. Example: A student can submit an assignment before the deadline.

Non-functional requirements

Describe qualities such as performance, security, usability and availability.
Example: The login page loads in under two seconds.

The SRS document

The Software Requirements Specification captures scope, stakeholders, functional and non-functional requirements, constraints and acceptance criteria.